Scott Spitze, PhD

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Summary

I'm a labor economist with 3+ years experience in translating clients' economic questions into actionable intelligence. Notable projects I've led include evaluations of university systems such as North Carolina's (often using administrative data), the biggest independent measure of non-degree credential quality (leading both the work to standardize text data to extract credentials and to analyze the outcomes of the workers that get them), and a ranking of the best entry level jobs for non-college workers. I'm experienced in asking and answering research questions, cleaning and analyzing data, leading and mentoring research teams, and communicating with and understanding clients. I'm an expert in R and the tidyverse, including using these tools to interact with SQL databases.

Experience

The Burning Glass Institute

Senior Economist June 2023 - Present
Economist March 2022 - May 2023

I mainly work on client based projects studying how to improve outcomes for workers, either through education, skills, or occupation selection. Notable projects include

1. I led a system-wide analysis of the University of North Carolina (UNC) school system on a program-by-program basis. Using administrative data, I estimated long-run earnings and my team estimated the ROI for each program in the UNC system. We also used our own data to track worker occupation and location destinations and to estimate supply and demand for new graduates.
2. I led the analysis behind the Credential Value Index, which is the largest independent measure of non-degree credential quality. This work included standardizing raw text data on credentials and providers into standardized formats using NLP techniques (including LLM embeddings), building a data set based on worker career history profiles of credential earners and counterfactual workers who did not earn a credential but were demographically similar and worked in the same occupation, and analyzing worker outcomes to measure wage gains, promotion rates, skills learned, and more.
3. Led analysis for a report on the best starting jobs for non-college workers using a combination of public and private data sets on worker histories and job quality. (See NY Times coverage.)

I take client questions and translate them into actionable analysis.

I supervise fellow members of the research team: ensuring they have a balanced work load, regularly meeting for project feedback and advice, and checking the quality of their work.

Created an R package to streamline interaction with the company Snowflake server.

Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of Georgia, 2022

M.A. Economics (Doctoral Track), University of Iowa, 2018.

B.A. Economics, *Summa Cum Laude*, University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign, 2015.

Working Papers

"The Equilibrium Effects of Domestic Outsourcing"

"Currency Competition with Uncertain Acceptance: The Case of Cryptocurrencies" with Fan Liang

Honors & Awards

St. Louis Fed Ph.D. Internship 2021

Bonbright Graduate Assistant 2020-2021

Graduate College Summer Fellowship, University of Iowa 2017

Conference Presentations

2022 Society of Labor Economics, Minneapolis

2021 St. Louis Fed Ph.D. Interns Workshop

North American Summer Meetings of the Econometric Society, Montréal

2020 90th Annual Meeting of the Southern Economic Association, New Orleans

I-85 Macroeconomics Workshop, Atlanta Fed

2019 Mini Conference on Search and Money, Wisconsin School of Business, Madison

Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings, University of Georgia, Athens

Teaching

Principles of Macroeconomics, University of Georgia, Fall 2019

Principles of Macroeconomics, University of Iowa, Spring 2018

Miscellaneous

Programming Languages: Python, R, Stata

References

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